

HMF Design Clinic

Team Workbook

Cedarline Health Group · 4 use cases · 27 customer pain points · 400 points

YOUR TEAM

Team name: _____

Members: _____

Date: _____

How this workbook works

- You're a team of Cisco Solution Engineers helping Cedarline Health Group. Read their situation (next page), then work the four use cases.
- Each use case lists the customer's **pain points**. For each one you take on, write the **product / platform** that solves it and the **Solution-Engineer response** — how it addresses the concern and how it helps.
- Your proctor may assign a subset of pain points per use case. Each use case is scored out of 100 — four make 400.

Your four use cases

- ☐ **1 AI Security** — 7 pain points
- ☐ **2 Cloud Edge** — 6 pain points
- ☐ **3 DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall** — 5 pain points
- ☐ **4 Macro & Micro Segmentation** — 9 pain points

READ FIRST

The customer — Cedarline Health Group

A regional healthcare payer-provider: ~8,000 staff across four hospitals and thirty-one clinics, plus a claims-processing business. It grew by acquisition — a second data centre absorbed as-is — and is mid-flight into public cloud, now running AI workloads across it. After a March security incident the board asked what would have stopped it, and leadership still can't answer. Budget and executive attention are approved, but temporary.

- **Campus & clinics** — hospitals, clinics, billing workstations, remote staff, plus thousands of IoT/unmanaged devices. TLS everywhere, so most traffic is encrypted.
- **Two data centres** — DC-1 (owned) is effectively flat; DC-2 (acquired) has an inherited rulebase nobody can prove. Three firewall consoles; two engineers hold the knowledge.
- **Three public clouds + AI** — AWS, Azure, GCP with live AI apps, models, agents and MCP tools appearing faster than security can track.

TIP Name a **product**, not a category. Make your reasoning turn on something Cedarline actually said — that's what scores highest.

1

USE CASE 1 OF 4 · AI DEFENSE · RUNTIME · COMPLIANCE · SUPPLY CHAIN

AI Security

Why this matters. Cedarline's AI apps are live and exposed, and AI assets are spreading across the clouds faster than security can see them.

TIP Most answers here are **Cisco AI Defense** capabilities — runtime guardrails, model/app validation, supply-chain scanning, AI cloud visibility — plus **ISE** for device visibility. Name the specific capability.

This use case has **7 pain points**. Answer the ones your proctor assigns — each use case is scored out of 100.

1

PAIN POINT 1

"Our production AI applications are exposed to users, and we are worried about adversarial attacks like prompt injection or data exfiltration. How do we protect these apps in real-time without slowing down the user experience?"

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

2

PAIN POINT 2

"Under the EU AI Act, we are classified as a 'Provider' for our internal AI systems. We need to demonstrate robustness and cybersecurity compliance to satisfy Article 15. How does Cisco help us meet these specific requirements?"

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

3

PAIN POINT 3

"We are integrating various open-source models and third-party agents into our internal workflows. How can we ensure these assets aren't introducing vulnerabilities into our environment before they even go live?"

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

4

PAIN POINT 4

"We have thousands of IoT devices, printers, and guest users connecting to our network. We have no visibility into what these devices are or if they are compromised, leaving us vulnerable to unauthorized access."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

5

PAIN POINT 5

"We know AI is showing up across our cloud environments faster than security can track it. We're worried we have models, agents, datasets, and MCP-connected tools running without visibility or consistent controls."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

6

PAIN POINT 6

"We're concerned that vulnerable or compromised models, repositories, or MCP servers could enter development before we catch them. Traditional controls aren't designed to inspect the AI supply chain."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

7

PAIN POINT 7

"We're running AI workloads in cloud accounts, but we don't have a reliable way to see which models and AI assets are actually in use. We're also concerned about workloads reaching out to third-party AI models without security knowing about it. And even when we do know the traffic path, we need a practical way to inspect and enforce guardrails on prompt and response traffic in the cloud without changing every application."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

PROCTOR — SCORE

 / 100

Notes

2

USE CASE 2 OF 4 · MULTICLOUD · CONSISTENCY & CONTAINMENT

Cloud Edge

Why this matters. Workloads sprawl across AWS, Azure, GCP and on-prem — inconsistent policy, configuration drift, and lateral-movement risk.

TIP Think **one control plane**: Multicloud Defense + Security Cloud Control to define intent once and enforce everywhere; ISE for consistent identity-based access.

This use case has **6 pain points**. Answer the ones your proctor assigns — each use case is scored out of 100.

1

PAIN POINT 1

"We're deploying across AWS, Azure, and GCP, but each cloud has its own constructs and workflows."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

2

PAIN POINT 2

"If a breach occurs in one of our public cloud instances, we are terrified that the attacker will move laterally into our core on-premises systems. How can we contain these threats in a multicloud environment?"

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

3

PAIN POINT 3

"Our auditors require proof that our security controls are applied consistently across all our cloud workloads. Gathering this data from different cloud providers is a manual, time-consuming nightmare."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

4

PAIN POINT 4

"Our employees work from the office, home, and coffee shops. We are struggling to maintain a consistent security policy across these different locations, leading to complex, fragmented rule sets that are hard to manage."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

5

PAIN POINT 5

"We have workloads spread across AWS, Azure, and on-premises data centers. Managing security policies individually in each cloud environment is creating massive operational overhead and leading to inconsistent security posture."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

6

PAIN POINT 6

"We have workloads on-prem, in cloud, and in mixed environments, and policy consistency is becoming difficult. Every environment feels different, and we're worried about drift."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

3

USE CASE 3 OF 4 · PERIMETER · VISIBILITY & POLICY

DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall

Why this matters. A complex, mixed-vendor firewall estate with encrypted blind spots, unknown threats, and slow manual response.

TIP Secure Firewall + FMC + Security Cloud Control; **EVE** for encrypted visibility, **Snort ML** for unknown threats, **ISE** for automated response and segmentation.

This use case has **5 pain points**. Answer the ones your proctor assigns — each use case is scored out of 100.

1

PAIN POINT 1

"When our security tools detect a compromised device, our manual response time is too slow. By the time we identify the user and manually isolate the port, the attacker has already moved through the network."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

2

PAIN POINT 2

"We're worried that once an attacker gets into the environment, they can move laterally across applications."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

3

PAIN POINT 3

"Our firewall environment has become too complex to manage manually."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

4

PAIN POINT 4

"Most of our traffic is encrypted, so we've lost visibility into a huge part of our environment."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

5

PAIN POINT 5

"We're worried traditional signature-based detection won't catch new or unknown attacks quickly enough."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

4

USE CASE 4 OF 4 · EAST-WEST · WORKLOAD & KUBERNETES

Macro & Micro Segmentation

Why this matters. The data centre and Kubernetes are wide open east-west; Cedarline needs policy that follows the workload — safely, without breaking apps.

TIP Secure Workload for dependency-aware policy, **Hypershield / N9300** for fabric enforcement, **Isovalent Cilium + Tetragon** for Kubernetes.

This use case has **9 pain points**. Answer the ones your proctor assigns — each use case is scored out of 100.

1

PAIN POINT 1

"We don't feel like we have enough control over east-west movement inside the data center."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

2

PAIN POINT 2

"Network policy helps, but we also need to know what's happening at runtime inside the workload. We need better detection of suspicious behavior and policy violations."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

3

PAIN POINT 3

"Our Kubernetes environment changes too fast for traditional segmentation approaches. We need policy at the service and container level, with visibility into microservice communication."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

4

PAIN POINT 4

"Our Kubernetes networking feels fragmented across clusters and environments. We're dealing with too many moving parts, inconsistent policies, and too much operational complexity."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

5

PAIN POINT 5

"Pods and services are constantly changing, so traditional IP-based policy is hard to maintain. We need segmentation that actually follows the application."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

6

PAIN POINT 6

"Right now we're stitching together separate tools for networking, security, and observability in Kubernetes, and it's creating too much overhead."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

7

PAIN POINT 7

"We know we need microsegmentation, but we don't have enough visibility into east-west flows or application dependencies to create policy safely. We don't want to break the application."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

8

PAIN POINT 8

"We like the idea of workload-level enforcement, but in some environments we can't install agents on every system. We still need segmentation coverage for those workloads."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

9

PAIN POINT 9

"We need Kubernetes networking and security that can perform at scale, support mission-critical workloads, and integrate with the rest of our enterprise tooling."

Product / platform

SE response — how it addresses the concern & how it helps

PROCTOR — SCORE

_____ / 100

Notes

FINISH

Your scoreboard

#	Use case	Score
1	AI Security (7 pain points)	_____ / 100
2	Cloud Edge (6 pain points)	_____ / 100
3	DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall (5 pain points)	_____ / 100
4	Macro & Micro Segmentation (9 pain points)	_____ / 100
TOTAL		_____ / 400

Well played. You turned a pile of problems into a plan — the way a great SE does in the real room.

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